



PACKED
AGENCY

The Ottawa Contractor's Marketing Checklist.

34 boxes that decide whether your phone rings —
Google, reviews, website, follow-up and lead costs. Free, no fluff.

How to use this

Print it. Walk through each section with a coffee. Tick what you already do.

Every empty box is a leak — fix them top to bottom, they're ordered by impact.

Stuck? The free 10-point audit applies all of this to YOUR business: packedagency.ca/free-audit



SECTION 1 OF 5

Your Google listing (10 minutes)

- ☐ **Primary category is your exact trade**
“Plumber”, not “Contractor”. The single biggest ranking lever on Google Maps.
- ☐ **Every service listed as its own item**
Furnace repair, drain cleaning, panel upgrades — each with one sentence.
- ☐ **10+ real job photos uploaded**
Trucks, crews, finished work. Phone photos beat stock photos, always.
- ☐ **Service areas set to neighbourhoods you want**
Not the whole city — the areas you actually want to drive to.
- ☐ **Q&A section answered by you**
Before a stranger answers it wrong.
- ☐ **One post per week**
A finished job with one photo counts. Do it from the truck.

PACKED TIP

A verified Google Business Profile is now mandatory to run Google's pay-per-lead ads — and since 2025 your profile reviews directly power those ads' ranking. This page is your marketing foundation.



SECTION 2 OF 5

Reviews (the tie-breaker)

- ☐ **You ask at the moment of thanks**
When the customer says “this is great” — that’s the window. Not three days later.
- ☐ **Direct review link sent by text within 10 minutes**
Search “Google review link generator” — it’s free.
- ☐ **2-3 fresh reviews per month**
Velocity beats volume. 2-3 monthly beats 50 old ones.
- ☐ **You reply to every review — especially bad ones**
Replies are ranking signals. Future customers read your reply more than the complaint.
- ☐ **Nobody on your team uses quotas, tablets, or name-drops**
Google’s 2026 policy formally bans review quotas and on-premises pressure. Penalty: wiped reviews.

PACKED TIP

Two contractors, same distance: the one with 150 fresh reviews wins almost every time.



SECTION 3 OF 5

Your website (7 leaks)

- ☐ **Phone number is clickable on mobile**
60%+ of visitors are on phones. Test it on your own phone, on data.
- ☐ **Quote form visible without scrolling**
Visitors won't hunt for it.
- ☐ **Loads in under 3 seconds**
Every extra second loses visitors before they see anything.
- ☐ **Real photos — your trucks, your crews**
Homeowners can smell stock photos.
- ☐ **Reviews shown on the page itself**
Proof where the decision happens.
- ☐ **A page per service and per area**
One generic page can't rank for twenty searches.
- ☐ **Something happens when a form is submitted**
An instant text or email reply — silence kills leads (next page).

PACKED TIP

About 90% of contractor websites fail to turn visitors into calls. The fixes above are ordered by impact.



SECTION 4 OF 5

Follow-up (where money leaks)

- ☐ **Missed calls get an instant text back**
85% of callers who hit voicemail don't leave a message — they call the next name on Google.
- ☐ **Every new lead gets a response within minutes**
80% of sales take 5+ contacts. Most contractors stop at one.
- ☐ **End-of-day 5-minute rule**
Every missed call and open quote gets one text before you go home.
- ☐ **“Quote sent” reminder after 3 days**
One text. Most competitors never send it.
- ☐ **You know your missed-call number**
Calculator at packedagency.ca/calculator — takes 20 seconds, usually hurts.

PACKED TIP

New in 2026: Google now tracks how fast you answer calls from its ads — slow answerers rank lower and pay more per lead. Speed stopped being good manners; it's a ranking factor.



SECTION 5 OF 5

Lead costs (so nobody rips you off)

- ☐ **You know your cost per LEAD on every channel**
LSA for HVAC: \$60-120. Managed search ads: ~\$50-60/call. Home-services average: ~\$91.
- ☐ **You know your cost per WON JOB**
Shared marketplace leads get sold to up to 5 competitors — your real cost per won job is far higher than the sticker.
- ☐ **You dispute junk LSA leads**
Most contractors never do. Credits are real money.
- ☐ **Anyone quoting you prices answers in numbers**
What does a lead cost through you? Do I own the accounts? Can I see call tracking?
- ☐ **You're building owned channels, not just renting leads**
Top-3 map placement runs ~40% lower cost-per-sale than ads — and it compounds.

PACKED TIP

If a quote lands far outside these ranges — in either direction — ask why, and make them answer in numbers.



Ticked everything?

You're ahead of 90% of contractors.

For the empty boxes: fix them yourself with the free guides at packedagency.ca/resources, or let us run all 34 checks against your business — the Free Schedule Audit is a 10-minute recorded video of exactly where your leaks are. No meeting. No pressure. No cost.

packedagency.ca/free-audit

Three promises, in the contract

1. You own everything we build — website, accounts, data.
2. No lock-in after a 90-day initial term. Month-to-month.
3. One client per trade, per city. Your competitor can't hire us.